that have long dominated governance in this country. In October 1986, Congress leader Ajit Jogi drafted a note for Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi, suggesting the hire of pro-Congress non-governmental organisations in Punjab to carry out constructive programmes for the youth. The idea, it appears from his note, was to ensure political dividends for the Congress. The note said:

During the most impressionable period in their lives, they saw the cult of Jarnail Singh Bhindranwale at its peak and imbibed the feeling of the superiority of Sikh race over all others just as the Germans under Hitler were led to believe about the Aryan race. They also witnessed 'Operation Blue Star' which intensely hurt their ego and filled them to the brim with a bitter sense of vengeance. Relative affluence, availability of cheap labour from other states and optimum level of mechanization in Agriculture leaves the uneducated amongst them almost free and idle. Growing unemployment, similarly, leaves them educated, frustrated, idle and full of excess energy. As a consequence, new terrorists are being born every day. Thanks to Julio Ribeiro a large number of them get killed or captured but a larger number join the ranks of terrorists every day.

Obviously bullets alone is not the answer to this gravest ever danger faced by our body politic. The limitless energy of the youth of Punjab, therefore needs to be directed in constructive channels so that they do not get attracted/di-verted towards the adventure of terrorism.

American intelligence, it appears, was closely monitoring the situation in Punjab. Before Rajiv Gandhi's attempts at confidence building measures, the CIA had predicted that he would probably take several steps to resolve Sikh discontent.